

**what does it mean
to make, alongside AI?**

presentation assets:

<https://drive.google.com/drive/u/0/folders/1SmhknYJ9Fi-dKZpdk6qErIK3SWlrrQes>

who i am

what i came in with

- Passionate about filmmaking and storytelling
- San Francisco trip before semester started
- Rooms full of young founders, everything AI
- The doomers: building the thing they feared
- That tension became the question for this semester

the brief

emerging technologies · create lens

A note: DES300 was completed last semester. Rather than force a connection that isn't there, I'm speaking honestly to the local issue I identified through my own research and the brief I chose.

- Emerging Technologies, Create lens
- Local issue: everyday creatives in Aotearoa facing AI displacement
- SF showed where that conversation lands in 5 years
- Brief gave room to use media, speculative design, diegetic prototypes
- Create lens: how does emerging tech change what it means to make?

**how might we use speculative design to
help everyday creators in Aotearoa feel
what it means to work alongside AI, rather
than be replaced by it?**

the HMW question that drove every experiment from week 4 onwards

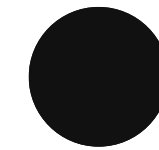
research

the scaffolding the work was built on

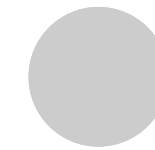
- Dunne & Raby (2013): speculative design opens debate, doesn't predict
- Kirby (2010): diegetic prototype: artefact from inside the future
- Emily is Away: interface as a world, being inside not watching
- Bandersnatch: active participant vs passive viewer
- Cluely launch video: confidence of format, product already exists

the process

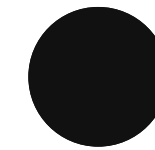
double diamond · diverge before converging



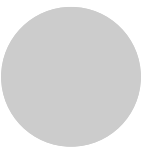
discover



define



develop



deliver

*Used this every time I felt the pull to commit too early.
Each experiment was information, not a commitment.*

11 experiments

in order, week by week

01 Claude Code (assignment tracker)

02 AI image generation

03 Storyboarding workflow

04 AI video generation

05 Suno music generation

06 Compass piano scenario + OpenCV

07 Wearable product research

08 Compositing + live footage shoots

09 Aotearoa Creative publication

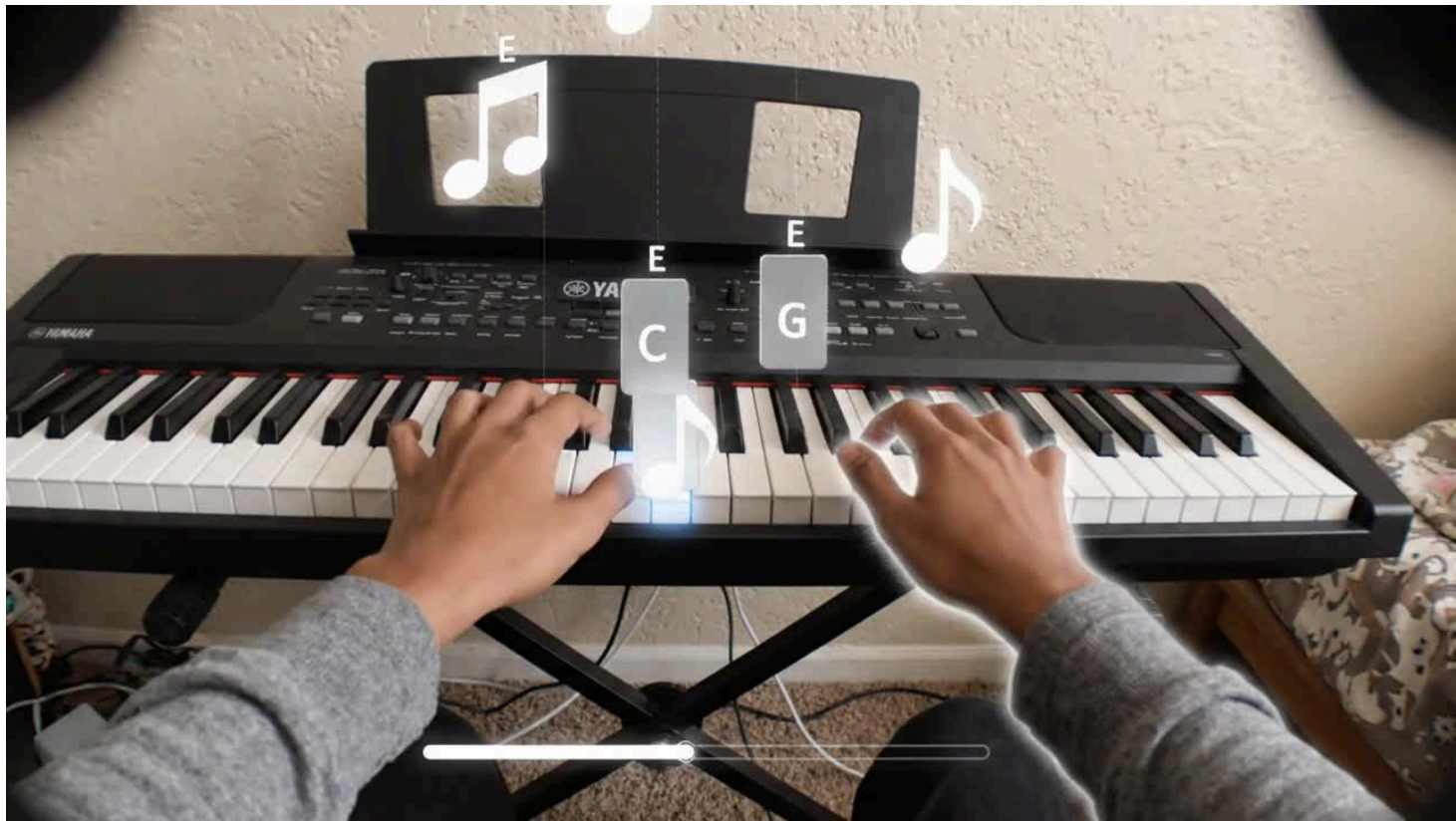
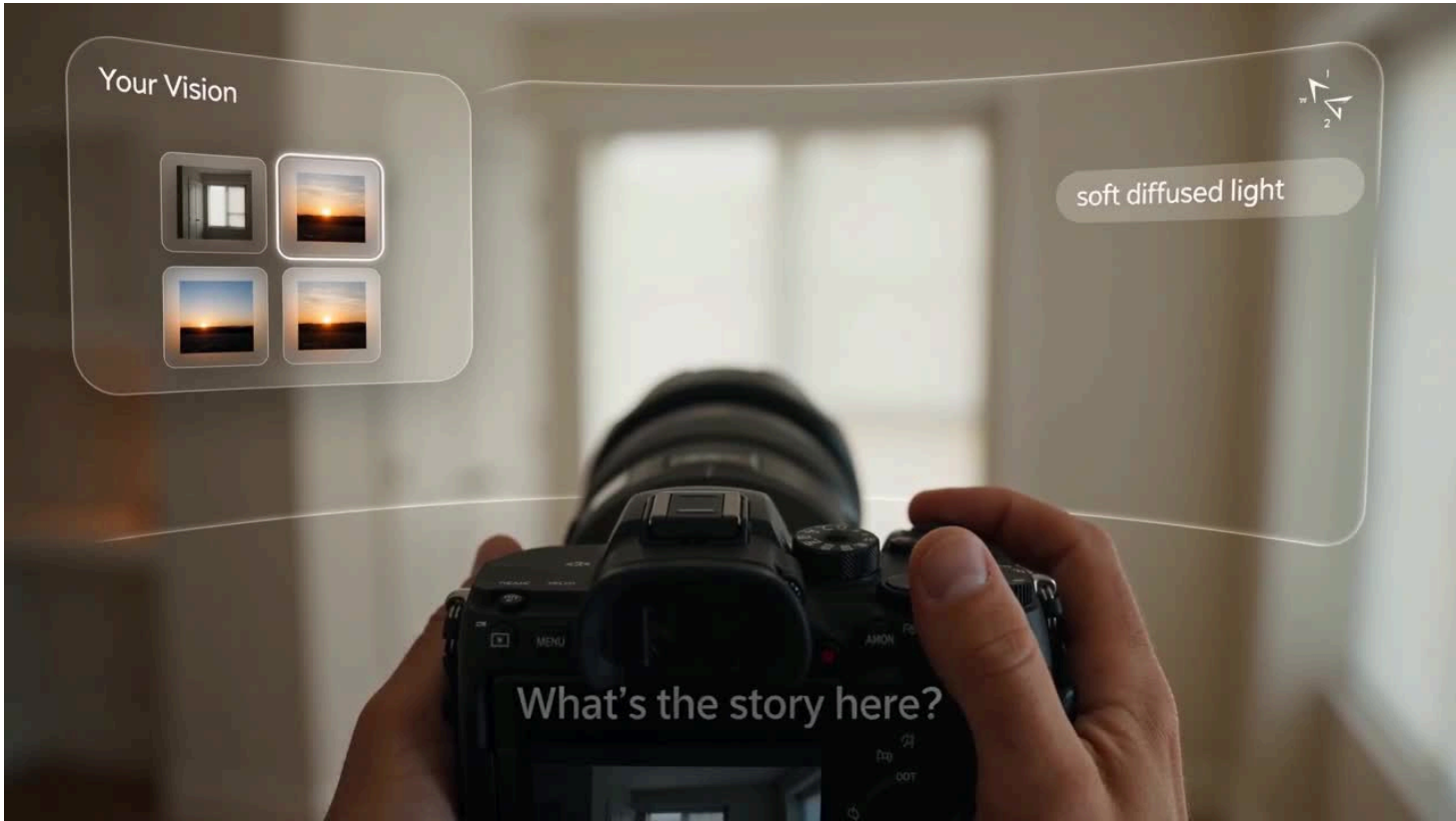
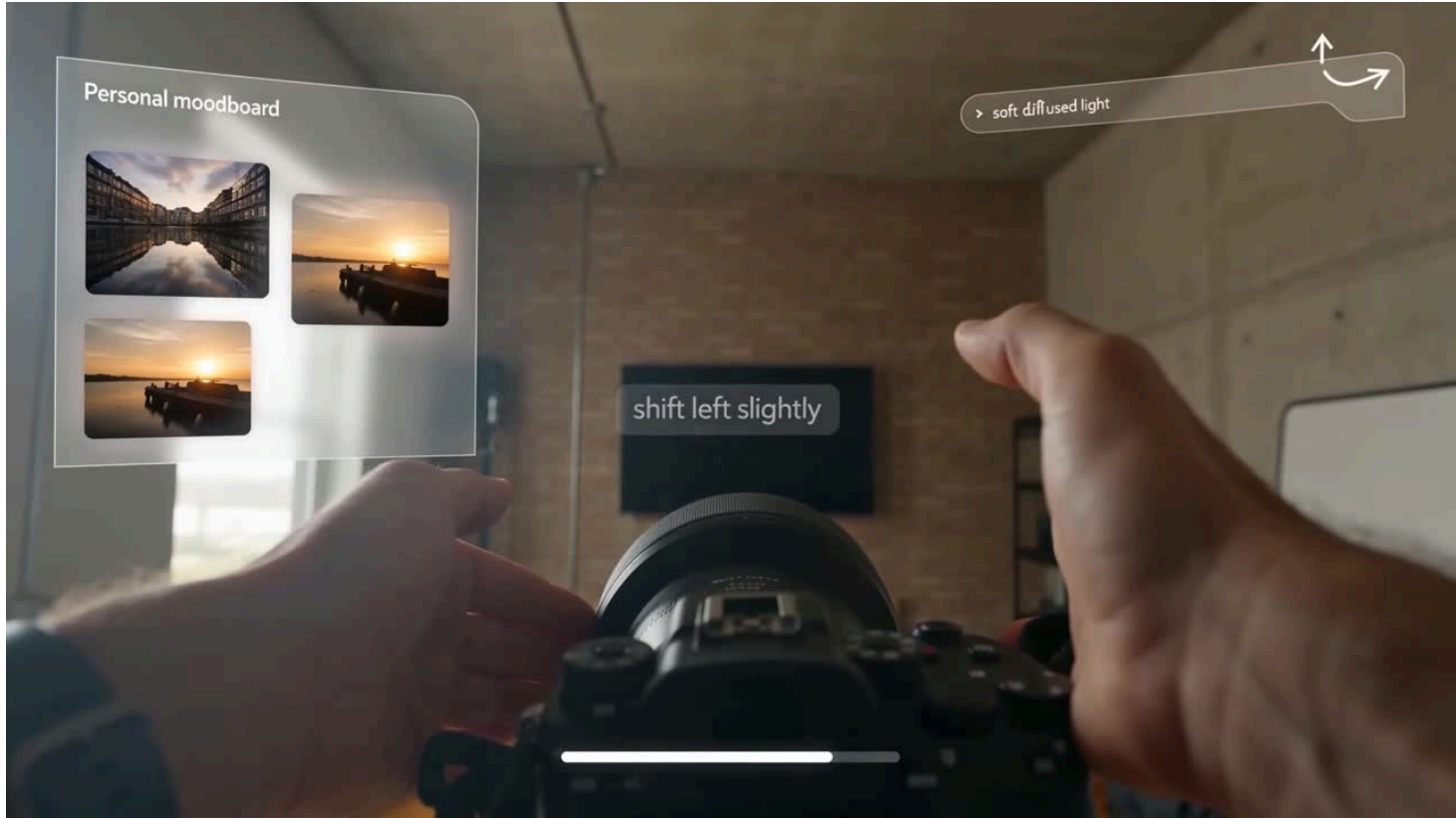
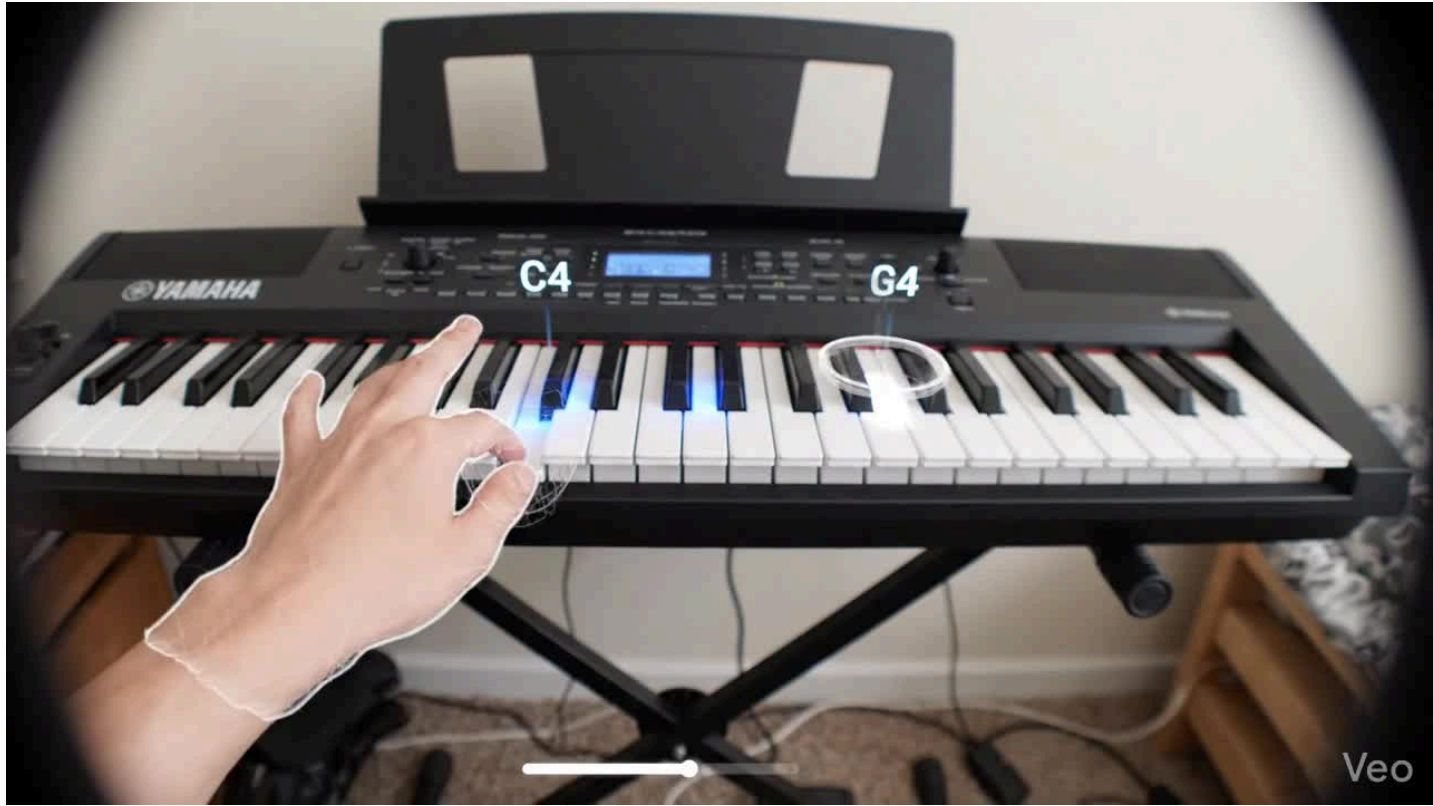
10 Muse V1

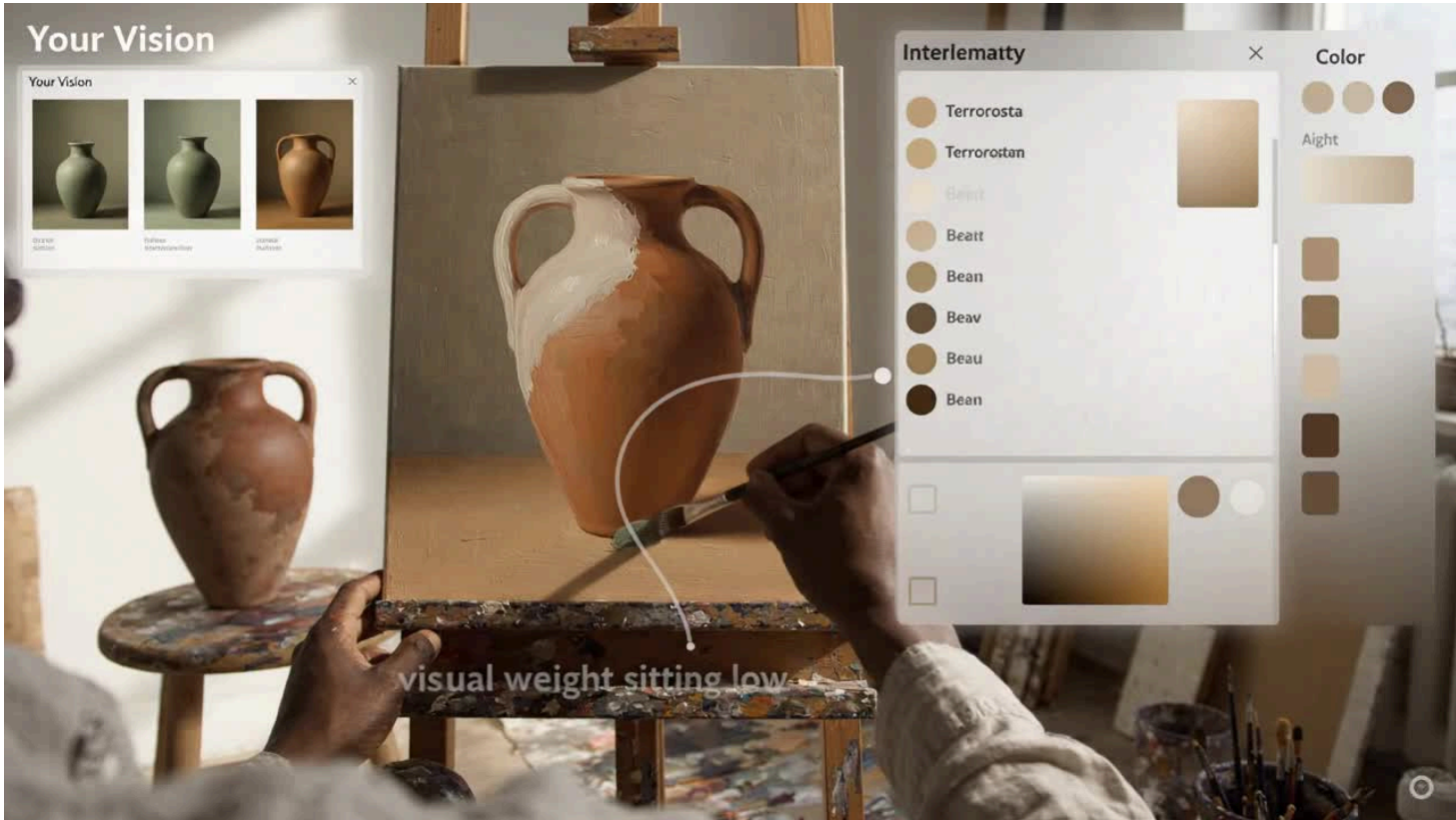
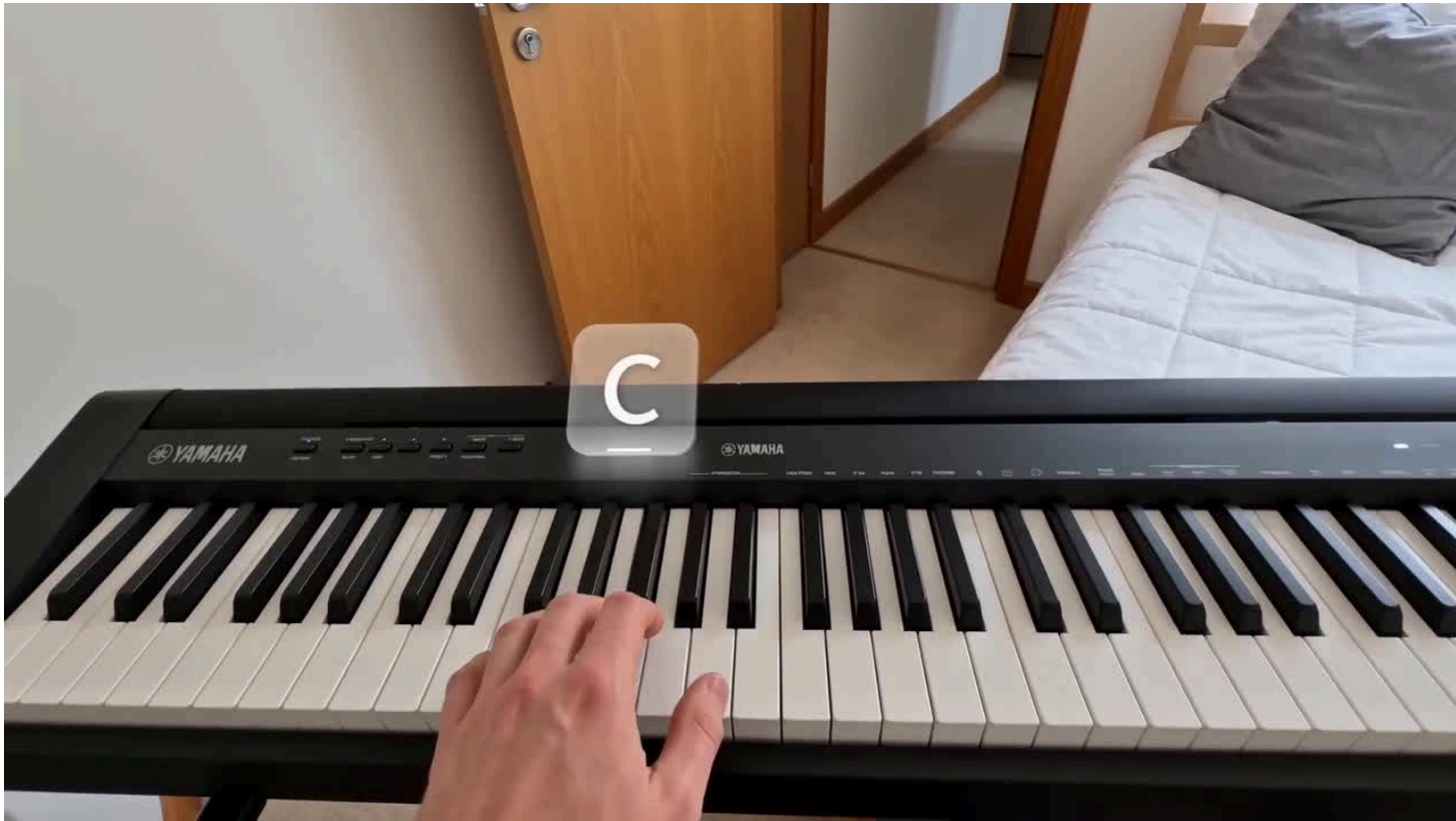
11 Muse V2

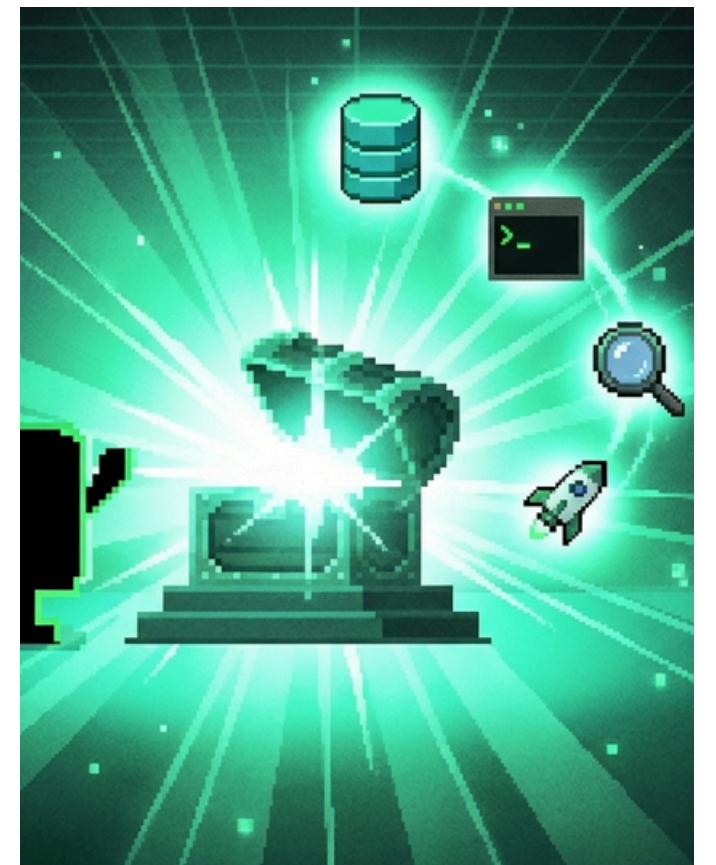
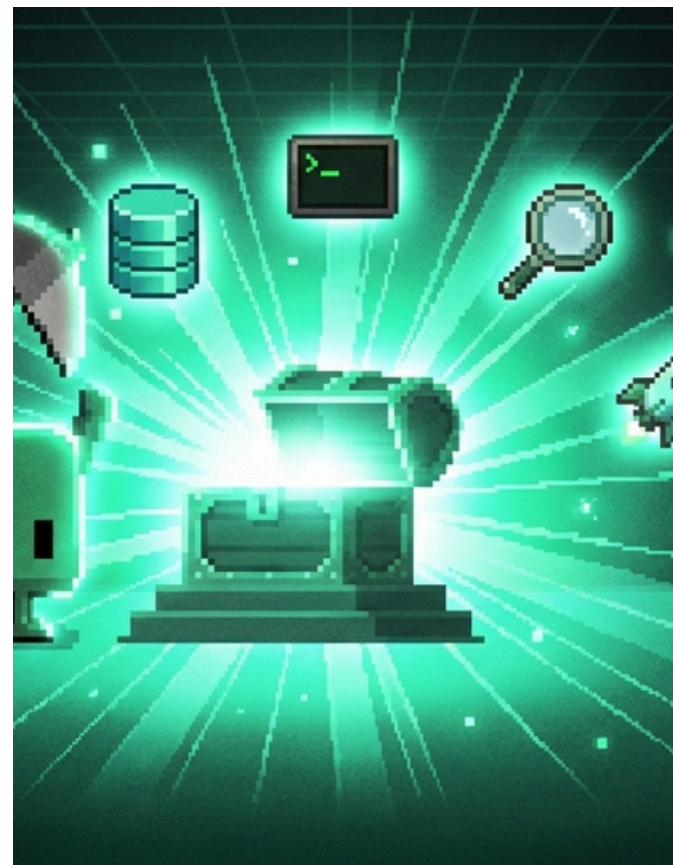
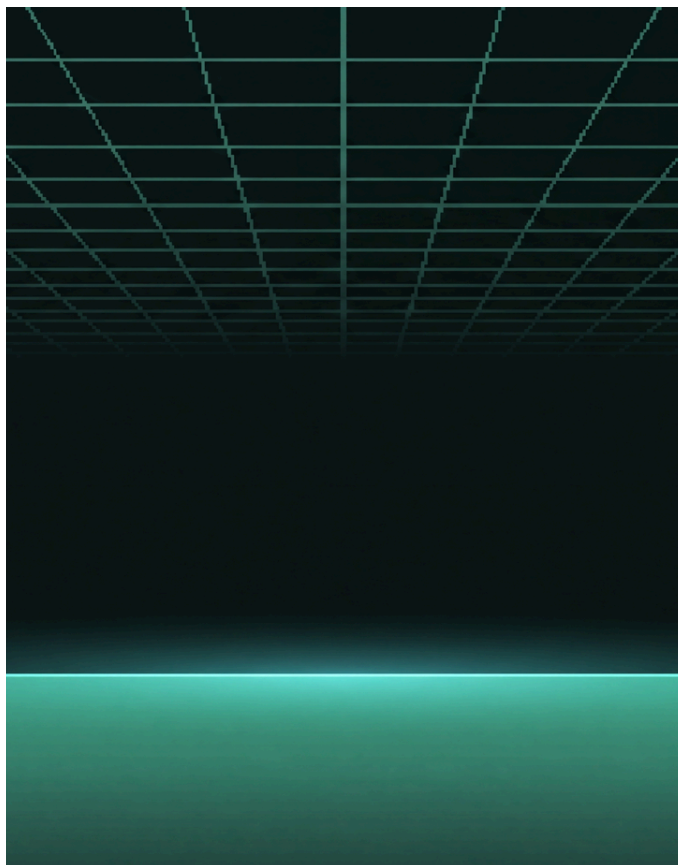
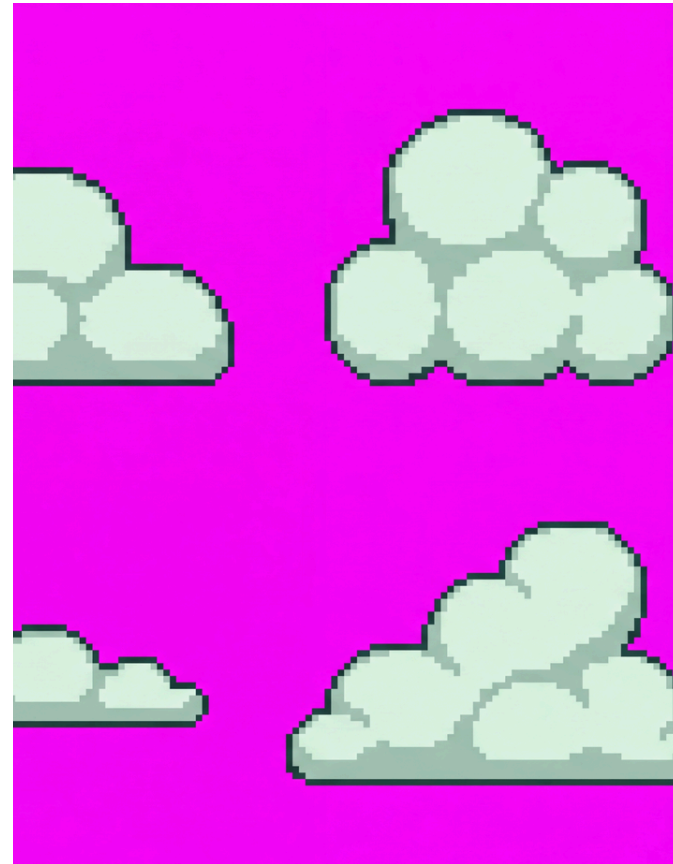
learning the tools

experiments 01 – 04

- Claude Code: think architecturally before prompting. Vague = broken output
- Image generation: natural language fails. Claude as intermediary was the unlock
- Storyboarding: describe → Claude refines → generation tool. Already using this outside course
- AI video: same lesson. Specific physical setup + persistent UI = better output







show insforge storyboarddemo

show final insforge video

the three artifacts

experiments 09 – 11

- Aotearoa Creative: built in Claude Code, masthead + article + radio segment. Format worked. Didn't survive crit
- Muse V1: single HTML file, one session, two endings. Broken choice mechanic. Proved concept
- Muse V2: four-file architecture, three days, five endings, leanScore, UI corruption. Interface shifts as autonomy transfers

play / show muse demo

the failures

honest and specific

- AI video outputs: my brief wasn't specific enough; that's the failure, not the tool
- Compositing: underestimated it as a craft skill. Treated it as a quick fix. It isn't
- Suno: music generation needs a concrete brief, not a feeling. Didn't spend enough time
- Muse V1: jumped into building before mapping the full architecture
- Journalism publication: execution confidence $\neq$ genuine investment

skills

before and after

before

- Commercial filmmaker
- Manual storyboarding
- Basic AI prompting

after

- Claude Code: built Muse V2 from scratch (4-file architecture, leanScore, UI corruption)
- AI image generation: Claude as prompt intermediary - already using outside course
- AI video generation: know the limits, know what works
- After Effects: orientation complete
- Prompt intermediary workflow: most transferable thing learned
- Speculative world building: a different kind of creative thinking

compass

primary capstone direction

video / product

- Speculative launch film for a fictional wearable AI companion for creatives
- Not a tech demo. Cinematic, and aspirational, closer to Apple Watch than Kickstarter
- Device assists but never creates. Prompts, doesn't perform
- Film communicates the feeling of having something that works with you, not for you
- Deepening of existing practice, not a stretch away from it

muse

alternative direction 01

- Choose-your-own-path game in Claude Code, inside a fake chat messenger
- Player is a creative in future Aotearoa choosing AI reliance vs personal instinct
- Five endings mapped to the score: Purist → Collaborator → Negotiator → Passenger → Ghost
- UI corruption shifts the visual environment as creative autonomy transfers to MUSE
- Genuinely distinct from the film: interactivity is the point

before 304

what to test, build, clarify

- Design the physical product first: everything else depends on it
- Actually learn After Effects: dedicated sessions, not tutorials
- Film POV demo experiments: piano, painting, photography in isolation
- Test Muse with cold audiences, only been seen by people who already know what it is. Friends, family etc

positionality

how it shaped specific decisions

- Came in from SF builder culture: not the average Aotearoa creative's relationship with AI
- Optimism gap shaped decisions: Muse has no right answer, Compass film leaves the question open
- Media fluency: journalism clicked fast because of execution comfort, not genuine investment
- Aotearoa specificity still unresolved: SF framing vs local context
- For 304: seek perspectives that aren't mine before concepts form, not after

how i operate differently

as a designer and researcher

- Reach for new tools first: build with it before deciding if it's worth learning
- Explore further: interesting things aren't visible in the first session. Stay longer
- External pressure as design tool: crits are where the real decisions happened
- Failure as information: every failure had a specific lesson, not a general one
- Came in as a filmmaker. Leaving as someone who can build interactive experiences, work across speculative formats, use AI as a genuine creative collaborator